Charcuterie Lab

FREE PRINTABLE

The Cheese Counter Card

Take it shopping: how much to buy, what to pick and how to serve it.

HOW MUCH CHEESE

- 2 oz per guest before a meal, 3 oz when the board is the party food, 4 oz when it's dinner. Add 10% from 20 guests.
- Three cheeses are plenty for 6 to 10 people. Split the total between them; blue cheese can be the smallest piece.
- Buy whole wedges or wheels and cut at home. Pre-cut cubes and slices dry out on the board.

PICK ONE FROM EACH LINE

☐ **Aged and hard**	Aged cheddar, aged Gouda, Parmigiano-Reggiano, Manchego
☐ **Semi-firm**	Gruyère, Comté, Havarti, young Gouda
☐ **Soft**	Brie, Camembert, triple-crème, fresh chèvre
☐ **Something bold**	Blue cheese, Taleggio, smoked Gouda

TAKE IT OUT OF THE FRIDGE BEFORE SERVING

Aged hard cheese	45–60 min
Semi-firm cheese	30–45 min
Soft cheese (brie, camembert)	20–30 min
Fresh cheese (chèvre, mozzarella)	15–20 min
Cured meats	about 20 min

AT THE COUNTER

- Ask for a taste. Good cheese counters expect it.
- Ask for it cut from the wheel, and how long it was aged.
- On imported cheese, look for the protected name on the label: Parmigiano-Reggiano DOP, Le Gruyère AOP, Manchego DOP.
- For pregnant guests, choose pasteurized cheeses and check the label.

LEFTOVERS

Wrap cut cheese in cheese paper or parchment, then loosely in plastic, and keep it in the warmest part of the fridge (the vegetable drawer). Anything that sat out more than 2 hours goes in the trash.